SURVEY REPORT ON EMERGING TRENDS IN

Low-Code Application Development Platforms

A Visual Guide to Ten Leading Low-Code Ecosystems

Submitted by

Keerthana M

Roll Number: 241401039

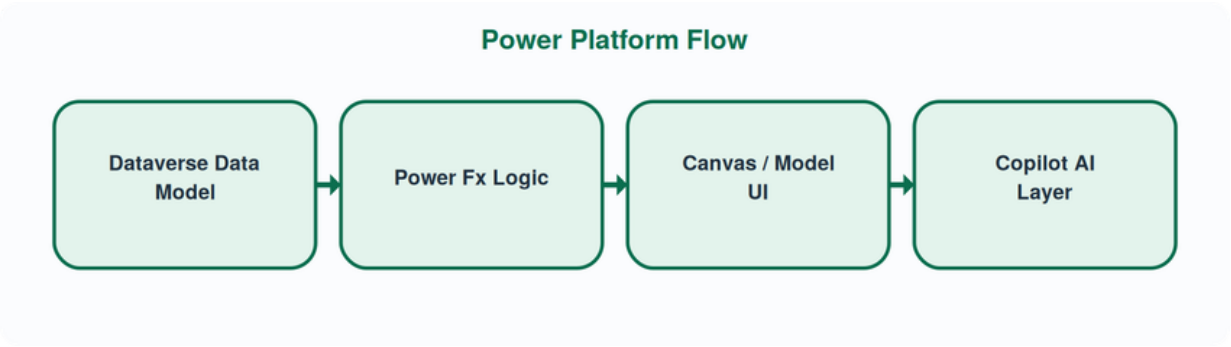
B.Tech Computer Science and Business Systems

Rajalakshmi Engineering College, Chennai (Batch 2024–2028)

August 2026

1. Microsoft Power Apps

EnterpriseBusinessProcess&ApplicationPlatform



> **Core Focus:** Rapid business-application delivery built on Dataverse, with canvas and model-driven app types wired natively into the Microsoft 365 and Azure ecosystem.

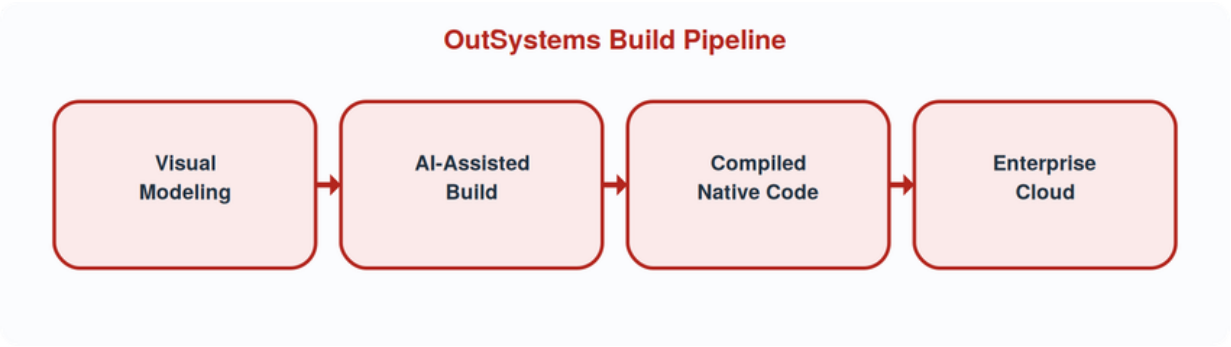
Key Features & Capabilities

- **Canvas & Model-Driven Apps:** Pixel-perfect canvas apps for custom UI, plus model-driven apps generated directly from the Dataverse schema.
- **Deep Microsoft Integration:** Native connectivity with Teams, SharePoint, Dynamics 365, and over 1,000 pre-built connectors into Azure services.
- **Copilot-Assisted Building:** Generative AI support to draft app layouts, write Power Fx expressions, and query data in natural language.
- **Power Fx Formula Language:** An Excel-like expression language that keeps logic approachable for citizen developers while allowing pro-code extension via PCF components.

24140103

2. OutSystems

High-PerformanceEnterpriseApplication Development



Core Focus: A full-stack, enterprise-grade platform aimed at mission-critical core systems and customer-facing web and mobile applications at scale.

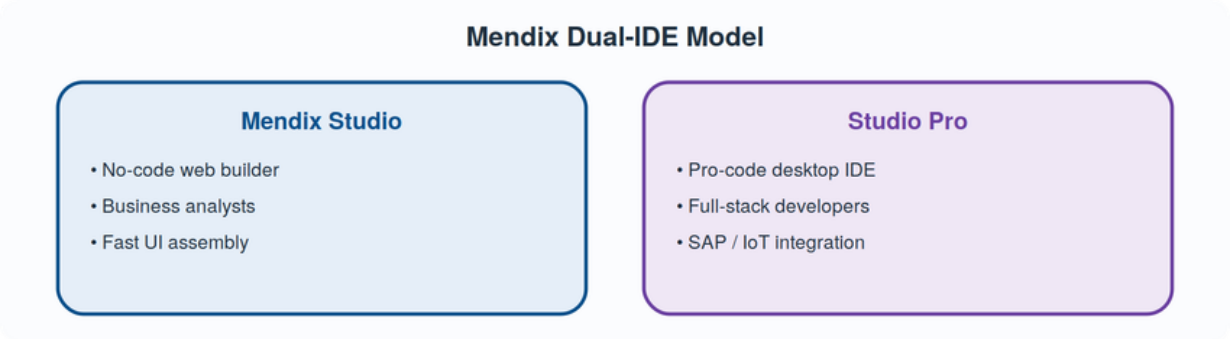
2414011039

Key Features & Capabilities

- **Full-Stack Visual Modelling:** Drag-and-drop design of UI, business logic, and relational data models, with built-in microservices support.
- **Standards-Based Output:** Compiles to conventional C#, JavaScript, and HTML5/CSS, reducing lock-in and keeping runtime performance high.
- **AI-Assisted Development:** In-editor suggestions for logic steps and automated code review to speed up build cycles.
- **Enterprise DevOps:** Continuous delivery pipelines, automated impact analysis, and role-based access control for governed releases.

3. Mendix

Multi-Experience&Industrial Low-Code Development Platform



Core Focus: A dual-audience platform for multi-experience enterprise apps and industrial solutions, spanning cloud, hybrid, and on-premises deployment. IoT

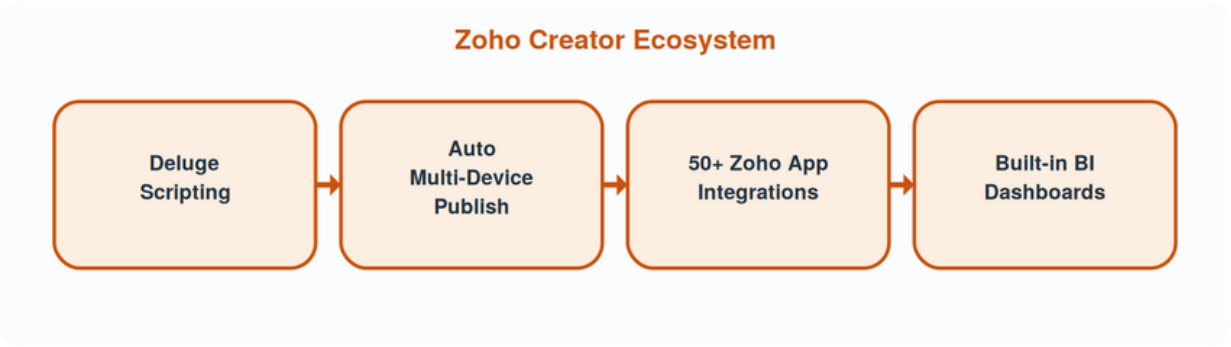
Key Features & Capabilities

- **Dual-IDE Environment:** Mendix Studio for citizen builders and Studio Pro for professional developers, sharing one underlying application model.
- **Siemens Industrial Fit:** Strong integration with Siemens Xcelerator, MindSphere, SAP, and PLM tooling for manufacturing and OT use cases.
- **Cloud-Native Deployment:** Container-based architecture that runs on AWS, Azure, Google Cloud, or self-managed Kubernetes.
- **AI Copilot Assistance:** Built-in AI guidance for data-model design, logic suggestions, and automated guardrails during development.

24140 1039

4. Zoho Creator

AffordableAll-in-OnePlatformfor SMB and Agile Teams



Core Focus: A cost-effective, all-in-one low-code platform built for small-to-midsize businesses and agile teams that need to ship custom applications quickly.

24140103

Key Features & Capabilities

- **Deluge Scripting:** An approachable, functional scripting language for business logic, event handlers, and cross-module workflow rules.

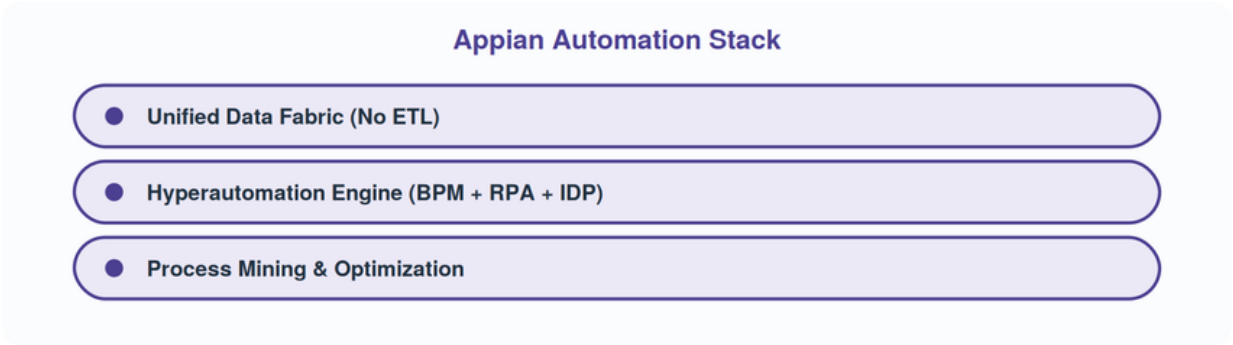
• **Automatic Multi-Device Publishing:** Applications render across web, iOS, Android, and tablet automatically, with no extra platform-specific work.

• **Native Zoho Ecosystem:** Seamless connectivity with 50-plus Zoho applications (CRM, Books, Desk, Analytics) alongside common external APIs.

• **Built-in BI & Reporting:** An integrated analytics engine offering dashboards, pivot tables, and scheduled report delivery out of the box.

5. Appian

End-to-EndEnterprise Process Automation & BPM



Core Focus: A process-first platform built around business process management, case management, and enterprise-scale hyperautomation.

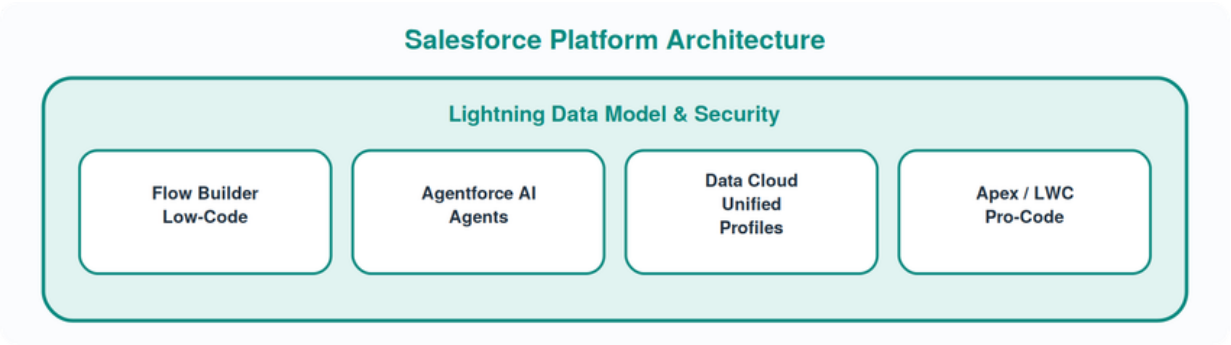
Key Features & Capabilities

- **Unified Data Fabric:** A virtual data layer that connects existing databases and APIs directly, avoiding heavy ETL migration work.
- **Hyperautomation Engine:** Combines BPM, robotic process automation, and intelligent document processing within a single design surface.
- **Process Mining:** Built-in analysis of live workflows to surface bottlenecks and trigger automated process improvements.
- **Regulated-Industry Readiness:** Pre-built case-management frameworks and compliance tooling suited to audited, multi-tier approval processes.

2141401039

6. Salesforce Platform

CRM-Centric App Development & AI Agent Orchestration



> **Core Focus:** A CRM-native development platform for customer portals, custom business apps, and orchestrated AI agents built on unified Salesforce data.

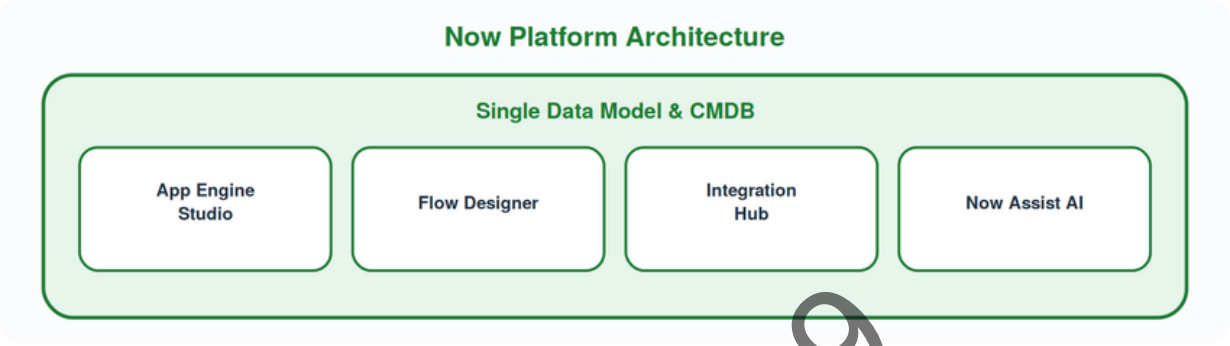
Key Features & Capabilities

- **Lightning & Flow Builder:** Drag-and-drop page layouts and visual process flows that handle most business logic without writing Apex.
- **Agentforce AI Agents:** A low-code builder for configuring autonomous, task-driven AI agents that act across CRM and Data Cloud.
- **Data Cloud Integration:** Direct access to real-time, unified customer profiles shared across every custom app and workflow.
- **Pro-Code Extensibility:** Native support for Lightning Web Components and Apex when an app needs deeper, custom logic.

24140103

7. ServiceNow

DigitalWorkflow&EnterpriseService Automation



Core Focus: An IT-centric workflow and enterprise service management platform, extending the Now Platform's single data model into custom applications.

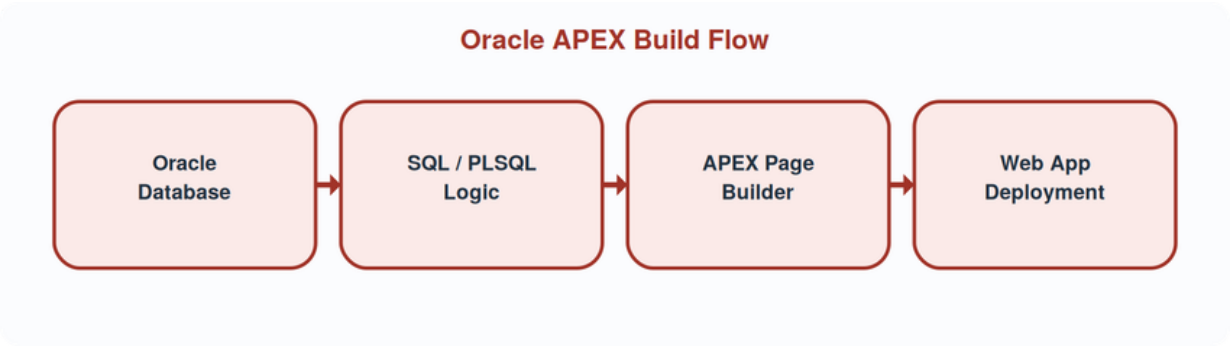
24140103

Key Features & Capabilities

- **Now Platform Native:** Built on the shared Now Platform data model, automatically inheriting security, CMDB records, and system objects.
- **App Engine Studio:** A visual builder that lets business creators and IT teams co-design workflows, data models, and mobile screens.
- **Flow Designer & Integration Hub:** A visual workflow engine paired with hundreds of pre-built spokes for SAP, Salesforce, Workday, and more.
- **Now Assist AI:** Generative AI features for workflow automation, script generation, and conversational interfaces.

8. Oracle APEX

Database-DrivenApplicationDevelopment on Oracle



Core Focus: A free, database-native low-code platform for building scalable, secure applications directly on top of the Oracle Database, from simple tools to mission-critical systems.

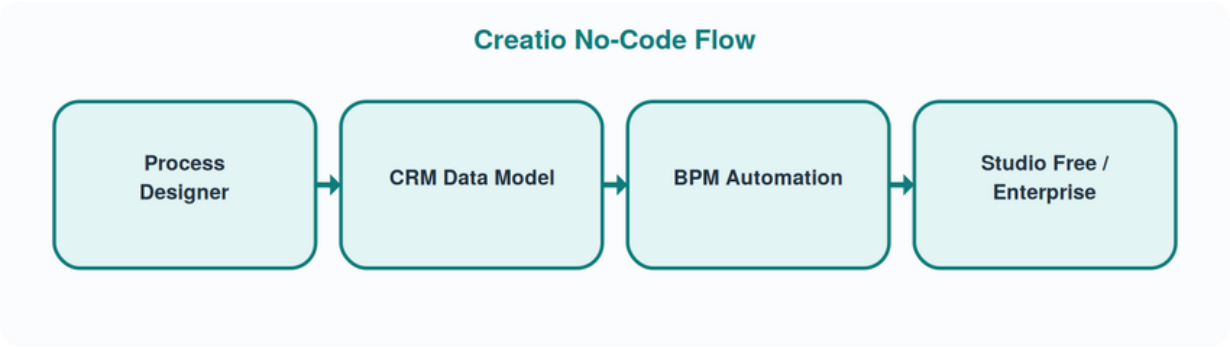
24140103

Key Features & Capabilities

- **Database-First Architecture:** Applications are built directly against the Oracle Database, so data logic and application logic stay close together.
- **SQL & PL/SQL Foundation:** Developers comfortable with SQL and PL/SQL can build sophisticated logic without a separate application server.
- **Included with Oracle Database:** No separate licensing cost for the platform itself when an organization already runs Oracle Database.
- **Enterprise-Grade Scalability:** Used for everything from spreadsheet replacements to large, mission-critical systems serving thousands of users.

9. Creatio

No-CodeCRM&Workflow Automation Platform



Core Focus: A platform that combines CRM functionality with no-code business process management, aimed at teams that want workflow automation without heavy IT involvement.

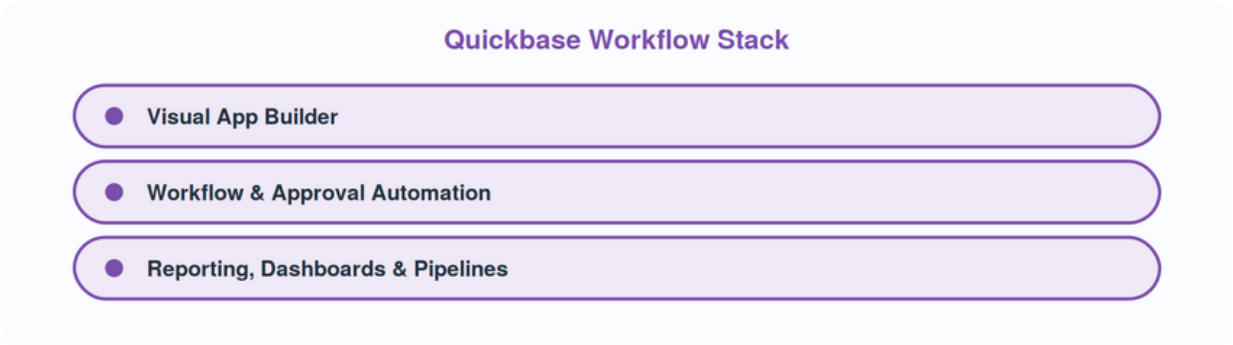
Key Features & Capabilities

- **Visual Process Designer:** A no-code designer for building and modifying business processes without waiting on development cycles.
- **Unified CRM Data Model:** Marketing, sales, and service data live in one model, so custom apps and processes share the same records.
- **Flexible Deployment:** Available as cloud, on-premises, or hybrid, giving organizations control over where data is hosted.
- **Composable Studio Tiers:** Free and enterprise studio options let teams start small and scale up as automation needs grow.

24140103

10. Quickbase

OperationalWorkflow&Reporting-Centric Application Platform



> **Core Focus:** A workflow-and-reporting-heavy low-code platform aimed at operations teams that need custom business apps with strong dashboards and process tracking.

Key Features & Capabilities

- **Visual App Builder:** A drag-and-drop builder for tables, forms, and relationships suited to operational and project-tracking apps.
- **Workflow & Approval Automation:** Built-in automation for multi-step approvals, notifications, and status-driven business rules.
- **Strong Reporting Layer:** Advanced dashboards and reporting tools that make Quickbase a common choice for ops-heavy, data-driven teams.
- **Pipeline & App Integrations:** Connectors and APIs for linking Quickbase apps into broader operational and IT tool pipelines.

24140 1039

Low-Code Platforms Comparison Matrix

Platform	Primary Use Case	Developer Profile	Deployment	Key Advantage
Power Apps	Microsoft 365 / Dataverse business apps	Citizen + IT Pros	Microsoft Cloud	Deep M365 & Teams integration
OutSystems	Core enterprise & high-scale apps	Professional Devs	Cloud / Hybrid / On-Prem	Standard-code, high-performance output
Mendix	Multi-experience & industrial IoT apps	Citizen + Pro (Dual IDE)	Cloud / Hybrid / On-Prem	Siemens OT/IoT ecosystem fit
Zoho Creator	SMB-to-midmarket business apps	Business Users + SMB Devs	Zoho Cloud	Fast, affordable Zoho-native builds
Appian	BPM, case management, automation	Process Architects	Cloud / On-Prem	Data Fabric + native process mining
Salesforce Platform	CRM-centric apps & AI agents	SF Admins/Devs	Salesforce Cloud	Agentforce AI + unified customer data
ServiceNow	Enterprise workflow & ITSM extension	Enterprise IT Devs	ServiceNow Cloud	Unified CMDB & workflow engine
Oracle APEX	Database-driven enterprise apps	SQL/PLSQL Devs	Oracle Cloud / On-Prem	Free with Oracle DB, high scalability
Creatio	CRM + no-code process automation	Business Users + Devs	Cloud / On-Prem / Hybrid	CRM and BPM combined, no-code first
Quickbase	Ops workflow & reporting apps	Business Users + Devs	Cloud	Strong dashboards & approval workflows

24140103 9